

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 18

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1. Abet

Meaning: To help, encourage, or support someone in doing something wrong.

Tip to remember: Abet sounds like “a bet.” If you bet on a criminal plan and help it happen, you abet it.

Sentence: The guard was accused of abetting the thief.

2. Accessible

Meaning: Easy to reach, use, understand, or approach.

Tip to remember: Accessible comes from access. If you can access something easily, it is accessible.

Sentence: The professor made the difficult topic accessible to beginners.

3. Acquisitive

Meaning: Strongly desiring to get and possess things, especially wealth.

Tip to remember: Acquisitive comes from acquire. An acquisitive person always wants to acquire more.

Sentence: His acquisitive nature made him chase money constantly.

4. Amalgamate

Meaning: To combine or unite into one.

Tip to remember: Think of mixing different metals into one alloy. That is amalgamation.

Sentence: The two companies decided to amalgamate their research teams.

5. Attenuate

Meaning: To weaken, reduce, or make thinner.

Tip to remember: In engineering, attenuation means signal strength decreases. Attenuate means to reduce strength.

Sentence: Thick walls can attenuate wireless signals.

6. Augment

Meaning: To increase, enlarge, or strengthen.

Tip to remember: Augment sounds like “increase amount.” It means to add more.

Sentence: He took online courses to augment his technical skills.

7. **Aversion**
Meaning: A strong dislike or unwillingness.
Tip to remember: Aversion sounds like “avoid version.” If you have an aversion to something, you avoid it.
Sentence: She has an aversion to dishonest behavior.
8. **Blithe**
Meaning: Cheerful and carefree; sometimes careless about serious matters.
Tip to remember: Think of someone smiling lightly even when there is a serious problem. That is blithe.
Sentence: His blithe attitude toward deadlines annoyed the team.
9. **Contempt**
Meaning: Strong dislike or disrespect.
Tip to remember: Think of looking down on someone with disgust. That feeling is contempt.
Sentence: The corrupt official showed contempt for the law.
10. **Dawdle**
Meaning: To waste time or move slowly.
Tip to remember: Dawdle sounds like “delay.” If you dawdle, you delay by moving slowly.
Sentence: Do not dawdle before an important exam.
11. **Deflect**
Meaning: To turn something aside; to avoid direct attention or criticism.
Tip to remember: Think of a shield deflecting an arrow. A person can also deflect blame.
Sentence: The manager tried to deflect criticism by blaming the workers.
12. **Discount**
Meaning: To reduce in price; or to dismiss as unimportant or unlikely.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: discount does not always mean price reduction. It can mean ignore or underestimate.
Sentence: The scientist did not discount the possibility of error.
13. **Dissident**
Meaning: A person who opposes official policy or authority.
Tip to remember: Dissident sounds like “disagreeing resident.” A dissident disagrees with those in power.
Sentence: The dissident criticized the government’s censorship.
14. **Efficacious**
Meaning: Effective; producing the desired result.
Tip to remember: Efficacious sounds like effective. Both mean something works well.
Sentence: The new teaching method proved efficacious for GRE preparation.

15. **Equitable**
Meaning: Fair and just.
Tip to remember: Equitable comes from equality and equity. It means fair treatment.
Sentence: The committee proposed an equitable distribution of resources.
16. **Erratic**
Meaning: Unpredictable, irregular, or inconsistent.
Tip to remember: Erratic sounds like error. Erratic behavior is full of unexpected errors and changes.
Sentence: His erratic study schedule made progress difficult.
17. **Industrious**
Meaning: Hardworking and diligent.
Tip to remember: Industrious sounds like industry. Industrial workers are often busy and hardworking.
Sentence: The industrious student reviewed vocabulary every day.
18. **Inform**
Meaning: To tell; also, to give shape, character, or influence to something.
Tip to remember: GRE trick: inform can mean influence, as in “values inform decisions.”
Sentence: His rural background informed his research interests.
19. **Irksome**
Meaning: Annoying or irritating.
Tip to remember: Irksome sounds like “irk,” which means annoy. Something irksome gets on your nerves.
Sentence: The irksome noise made it hard to concentrate.
20. **Manacle**
Meaning: To restrain or handcuff; also, a handcuff or shackle.
Tip to remember: Manacle sounds like “manual lock.” It locks the hands.
Sentence: Fear can manacle creativity and prevent new ideas.
21. **Modest**
Meaning: Humble; not large, expensive, or extreme.
Tip to remember: A modest person does not boast; a modest amount is not big.
Sentence: Despite his success, he remained modest.
22. **Noxious**
Meaning: Harmful, poisonous, or very unpleasant.
Tip to remember: Noxious sounds like “toxic.” Both refer to harmful substances or effects.
Sentence: The factory released noxious gases into the air.
23. **Pernicious**
Meaning: Very harmful, especially in a gradual or hidden way.

Tip to remember: Think of poison spreading slowly through the body. That hidden harm is pernicious.

Sentence: Misinformation can have a pernicious effect on society.

24. **Predicament**

Meaning: A difficult, unpleasant, or embarrassing situation.

Tip to remember: Think of being stuck in a problem with no easy way out. That is a predicament.

Sentence: Losing his passport put him in a serious predicament.

25. **Proficient**

Meaning: Skilled or competent at something.

Tip to remember: Proficient sounds like “professional efficient.” A proficient person does something well.

Sentence: She is proficient in MATLAB and Python.

26. **Prolix**

Meaning: Using too many words; long and wordy.

Tip to remember: Prolix sounds like “pro-long.” A prolix answer is unnecessarily long.

Sentence: The prolix report could have been summarized in two pages.

27. **Scorn**

Meaning: Strong disrespect; to reject or mock with contempt.

Tip to remember: Scorn sounds sharp and harsh, like a person looking down on someone.

Sentence: She scorned the idea because it lacked evidence.

28. **Subordinate**

Meaning: Lower in rank or importance; to treat as less important.

Tip to remember: “Sub” means under. A subordinate is under someone in rank.

Sentence: Personal desires should sometimes be subordinate to team goals.

29. **Unseemly**

Meaning: Improper, inappropriate, or not socially acceptable.

Tip to remember: Unseemly means something does not seem proper.

Sentence: His loud argument at the formal dinner was unseemly.

30. **Veritable**

Meaning: True, real, or genuine; used for emphasis.

Tip to remember: “Veri” means truth, as in verify. Veritable means truly or genuinely.

Sentence: The library was a veritable treasure house of knowledge.